Artem Sholokhov

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Summary

Hands-on engineering leader with 14 years of experience building distributed systems, data and AI platforms, and developer tooling. Joined XITE as one of its first engineers, scaled the product from 1K to 2.5M MAU and built the engineering organization with 50+ hires, while leading system design and driving cost/performance optimization. Deep expertise in Scala, stream processing, and cloud-native architecture.

Experience

Director of Engineering, XITE Networks – Amsterdam, The Netherlands September 2020 – Now

Scala (cats, cats-effect, fs2, http4s, circe, scalatest), Python, Bazel, gRPC, Protobuf, GCP, Kubernetes, Kafka, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Jaeger, ArgoCD, ClickHouse, Airflow, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, GraphQL

- Rebuilt data infrastructure from scratch on ClickHouse, Superset and Airflow — **135B+ rows (125+ TB raw at ~13× compression), ingesting 1.4B+ rows/day** — while **reducing running costs by more than 85%**; it became the **critical enabler for ML-powered Recommendation Systems** (incl. embedding search in ClickHouse).
- Led AI engineering: designed and developed XITE's internal LLM agent platform (each run an ephemeral Kubernetes Job with a per-run USD budget, privacy-aware routing between SOTA models and on-prem Ollama) and built the company-wide **MCP servers and CLI tooling** used by agents and engineers for **internal CMS operations**, **production debugging** and **content metadata**.
- Built and ran the core developer platform: DevOps/GitOps and MLOps around a **Bazel monorepo of 40+ microservices** shared by all products and teams (deployments from hours to minutes with automated test gates, **CI build time cut by 58% to under 2 minutes**), an observability stack at **~8B metric samples/day** and **560M trace spans/day**, and cloud cost analysis and optimization.
- Scaled the engineering organization (50+ hires across Data Engineering, Backend, Ops and ML teams) and owned platform architecture decisions end to end.
- Led complex technical integrations with major platforms by working directly (on-site) with partner engineering teams, including XITE SDK integration for Amazon Fire TV and Vevo.

Sr. Software Engineer, XITE Networks – Amsterdam, The Netherlands June 2018 – September 2020

- Joined as **one of the first four engineers** on a greenfield personalized music television product: built the core product and scaled services across EU, US and Asia (**from 1K to 2.5M MAU**) while helping grow the team from 4 to 30+ developers.
- Designed and built the AdTech stack and IAM/IAP integrations with various platforms (Roku, Apple, Amazon), which became the company's **main revenue sources**.

Sr. Software Engineer, JettyCloud (RingCentral) – St. Petersburg, Russia October 2016 – May 2018

Scala (Akka, cats, cats-effect, fs2, http4s, circe), SBT, Angular 5, gRPC, Protobuf, Docker, Kubernetes, Kafka, Prometheus, Grafana, GitLab, TensorFlow

- Designed and developed a Data Aggregation Hub platform using Event Sourcing, CQRS, and concurrent multi-source stream processing, forming the foundation for new company products and reducing running costs by nearly 10×.
- Worked on next-generation near real-time products based on the new platform, including Quality of Service monitoring, Live Calls Monitoring, and Historical Reports for call center analytics.
- Trained and deployed a TensorFlow model for Quality of Service prediction based on RTCP metrics, which quickly became the primary source for call quality scoring.

Software Engineer, NetCracker – St. Petersburg, Russia November 2015 – October 2016

Java, Kafka, Elasticsearch, Redis, Jenkins, Ansible, Docker, DevOps, Microservices

- Worked on a new Search Engine leveraging Change Data Capture and Kafka (Java, Elasticsearch, Redis), reducing time-to-index by 40%, and supported the company's internal high-availability service router.

Software Engineer, Seventest R&D Center – St. Petersburg, Russia November 2012 – November 2015

C++ (Qt, CORBA, boost), PHP, Web (AngularJS, Drupal), PostgreSQL, MySQL, Memcache

- Optimized the Billing Engine for interconnect traffic (C++/Qt/CORBA), reducing computation time by 25×, and delivered full-stack features across Service Quality Management, Revenue Assurance, Network Testing, and Telecommunications Fraud Management.

Skills

Engineering	Algorithms & Data Structures, Object Oriented Programming, Functional Programming, Design Patterns, Parallelism & Concurrency, Stream Processing, TDD/BDD, Performance Optimizations, Observability & Monitoring
AI & ML	LLM agent orchestration, Claude API, TensorFlow, MCP (tool federation, scoped credentials), prompt-injection defense, on-prem inference (Ollama), Recommendation Systems, Multi-Armed Bandits, token/cost accounting
Languages	Scala (cats, cats-effect, fs2, http4s, Akka), Java, Go, Python, Rust, C++, TypeScript, SQL
Architecture	Microservices, SOA, Monoliths, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Event Sourcing, CQRS, Cloud-native & Distributed Systems, Cloud Patterns, REST, GraphQL, gRPC/Protobuf
Data & Storage	ClickHouse, Superset, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis, Kafka, Airflow, S3/GCS
DevOps & Cloud	Linux, Nix, Docker, Kubernetes, Bazel, Monorepos, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, CircleCI, ArgoCD), Google Cloud Platform, Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry
Languages (Spoken)	English (fluent), Russian (native), Dutch (B1)

Education

The Bonch-Bruevich St. University of Telecommunications, St. Petersburg September 2010 – May 2015

Specialist degree (MSc equivalent) in Computer Science and Software Engineering in Telecommunications.
Lab assistant 2012–2016: taught Algorithms & Data Structures and OOP, built the contest judging system.

Relevant Activities

Occasional consulting – software architecture reviews and technical due diligence 2024 – Now
Competitive programming – ACM ICPC/NEERC (Semifinal 2013), KPI-Open 2011 – 2013

Talks

Introduction to Bazel • Introduction to Rust • Agentic Coding at XITE • sholokhov.pro/talks

Open Source & Side Projects

- **http4s/blaze** – github.com/http4s/blaze/pull/359 – Fixed SSL handshake infinite recursion (OpenJDK 11 bug).
- **redis4cats** – github.com/profunktor/redis4cats/pull/47 – Added Redis Cluster support to the Effects API.
- **rules_scala** – github.com/bazel-contrib/rules_scala/issues/779 – Bug reports, docs and protobuf workarounds.
- **DataBridge** (side project, Go) – github.com/DataBridgeTech/dbqctl – Data quality CLI that profiles tables and runs declarative YAML checks on ClickHouse, PostgreSQL and MySQL; checks compile to per-database SQL and run on a bounded concurrent worker pool.
- **logfish** (side project, TypeScript) – github.com/lograze/logfish – Kibana-style log explorer for ClickHouse with no backend: the browser queries ClickHouse's HTTP API directly with `readonly=1` enforced per query, so it ships as one static container.